

Zikun Ye

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EMPLOYMENT	Michael G. Foster School of Business University of Washington , Seattle, Washington Assistant Professor of Marketing 2023 - Present
EDUCATION	University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign , Illinois 2018-2023 Ph.D., Operations Research Shanghai Jiao Tong University , Shanghai, China 2014-2018 B.S., Industrial Engineering and Mathematics (Summa cum laude)
RESEARCH INTEREST	Large Language Models; Digital Marketplace; Quantitative Marketing; Optimization; Causal Inference; Field Experiment; Machine Learning.
PUBLICATIONS	† Authors listed alphabetically. * Student advised. 1. Zikun Ye, Hema Yoganarasimhan. Fair Document Valuation in LLM Summaries via Shapley Values. <i>Management Science</i>, forthcoming, 2026. [Link] 2. Shuai Li*, Zikun Ye, Xin Chen, Weijun Xie. Joint Assortment Optimization and Discrete Marketing Mix Allocation. <i>Manufacturing & Service Operations Management</i>, 2026. [Link] 3. Zikun Ye, Hema Yoganarasimhan, Yufeng Zheng. LOLA: LLM-Assisted Online Learning Algorithm for Content Experiments. <i>Marketing Science</i>, 2025. [Link] 4. Zikun Ye, Zhiqi Zhang, Dennis Zhang, Heng Zhang, Renyu Zhang. Deep-Learning-Based Causal Inference for Large-Scale Combinatorial Experiments: Theory and Empirical Evidence. <i>Management Science</i>, 2025. [Link] - Accepted at <i>ACM Conference on Economics and Computation</i> (EC'23) - First Prize, INFORMS Social Media Analytics Best Student Paper Award, 2023 - Second Prize, CSAMSE Best Paper Award, 2023 5. Xin Chen, Niao He, Yifan Hu, Zikun Ye[†]. Efficient Algorithms for a Class of Stochastic Hidden Convex Optimization and Its Applications in Network Revenue Management. <i>Operations Research</i>, 2024. [Link] 6. Zikun Ye, Dennis Zhang, Heng Zhang, Renyu Zhang, Xin Chen. Cold Start to Improve Market Thickness on Online Advertising Platforms: Data-Driven Algorithms and Field Experiments. <i>Management Science</i>, 2023. [Link] - Finalist, INFORMS RMP Section Jeff McGill Best Student Paper, 2020.

- WORKING PAPER 7. **Zikun Ye**, Jiameng Lyu, Rui Tao. Allocating Human Oversight in AI-Enabled Analytics, *major revision in Production and Operations Management*. [Link]
8. **Zikun Ye**, Jinglong Zhao, Lei Wang*. Fine-Tune, Then Rectify, *under review in Management Science*. [Link]
9. **Zikun Ye**, Hema Yoganarasimhan. Rectification Difficulty and Optimal Sample Allocation in LLM-Augmented Surveys, *in preparation*. [Link]
10. **Zikun Ye**, Walmart Global Tech. Seller-side Outcome Fairness in Online Marketplaces. Short paper *presented at NeurIPS 2023: Algorithm Fairness Workshop*. [Link]

CONFERENCE
PRESENTATIONS

Document Valuation in LLM Summaries.

WUSTL Marketing Junior Faculty Forum	2025
MIT DSL	2025
AIM 2025	2025
ISMS 2025	2025

LOLA: LLM-Assisted Online Learning Algorithm for Content Experiments.

ISMS 2024, Sydney	2024
UW-UBC	2024
Shanghai Jiao Tong University	2024
WUSTL Olin Business School	2024
QME, Stanford GSB	2024
MarkTech, Columbia CBS	2024

Deep-Learning-Based Causal Inference for Large-Scale Combinatorial Experiments.

China-India Insight Program, Hong Kong	2024
WUSTL Olin Business School	2024
ACM EC, London	Jul 2023
INFORMS RMP, London, UK	Jul 2023
MSOM Conference, Montreal, CA	Jun 2023
POMS Annual Conference	May 2023
2022 Conference on AI, ML, and BA, HBS	Dec 2022
NFORMS ISMS Conference, Online	Jun 2022

Efficient Algorithms for Minimizing Compositions of Convex Functions and Random Functions.

POMS Annual Conference,	May 2023
INFORMS Annual Meeting, Indianapolis	Oct 2022
MSOM SIG in SCM, Munich, Germany	Jun 2022
INFORMS RMP Spotlight Session, Online	Jun 2022
POMS Annual Conference, Online	May 2022

Cold Start to Improve Market Thickness.

MSOM SIG in Service Management, Munich	Jun 2022
INFORMS RMP Spotlight Session, Online	Jun 2022
MIW, Online	May 2022
POMS Annual Conference, Online	May 2022
Cornell ORIE Young Researcher Workshop, Ithaca	Oct 2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE	MKTG 464 Analytics for Marketing Decisions	
	MKTG 564 Analytics for Marketing Decisions	
	BUS AN 599 Business Analytics Practicum	
	MKTG 579 Business Applications of LLMS & Generative Models	
	IE 310 Deterministic Models in Optimization (UIUC)	
HONORS AND AWARDS	First Prize, INFORMS Social Media Analytics Best Student Paper Award	2023
	Second Prize, CSAMSE Best Paper Award	2023
	Finalist Jeff McGill Student Paper Prize, INFORMS RMP Section	2020
	Teachers Ranked as Excellent by Students, UIUC	2022
	William A Chittenden II Award, UIUC	2021
INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE	<i>Research Intern</i> , Walmart Lab	Summer 2022
	<i>Economist/Ops. Research Intern</i> , Kwai Inc.	2019 - 2020
	<i>Data Analyst Intern</i> , Didi.com	Summer 2018
ACADEMIC SERVICES	Editorial Review Board	
	- <i>Marketing Science</i>	
	Referee	
	- <i>Management Science</i>	
	- <i>Operations Research</i>	
	- <i>Journal of Marketing Research</i>	
	- <i>Manufacturing & Service Operations Management</i>	
	- <i>Production and Operations Management</i>	
	- <i>Conference - NeurIPS, ACM EC, WWW</i>	
	Session Chair, INFORMS Annual Meeting, 2022, 2023, 2025	
	Session Chair, ISMS 2025	

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